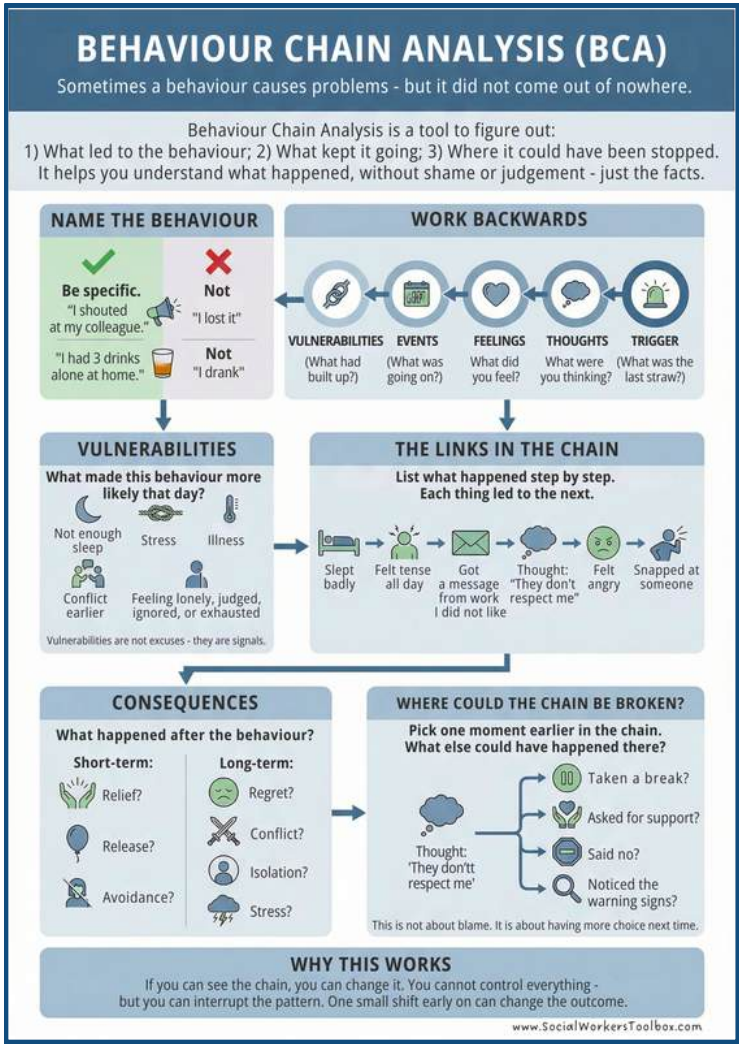
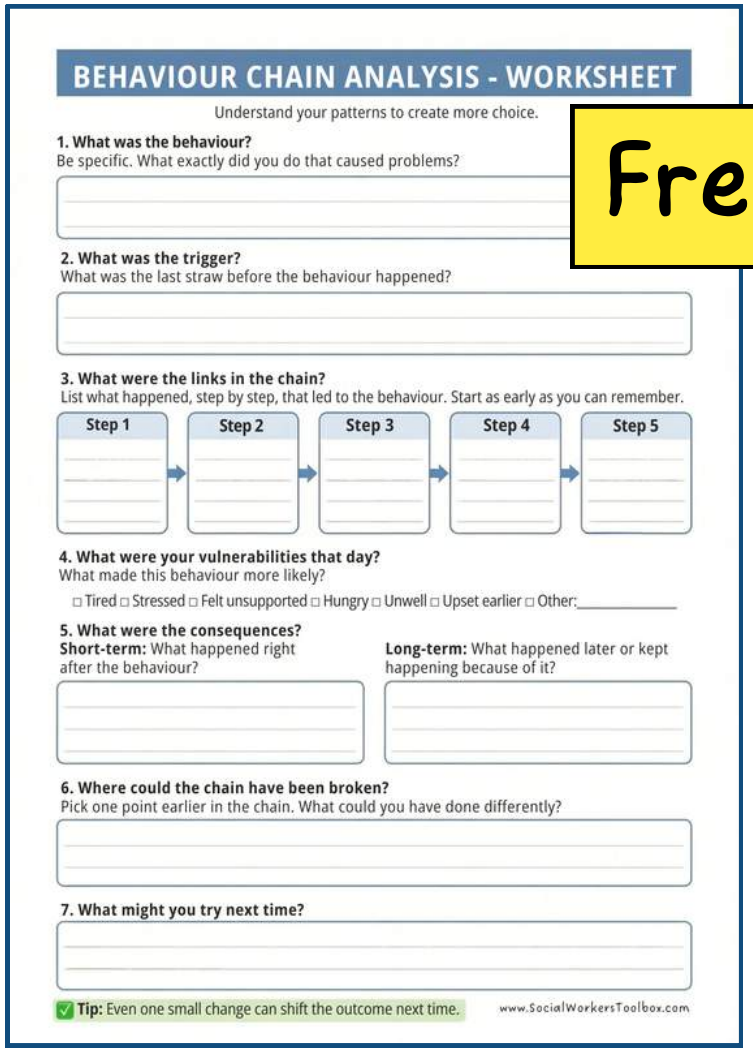
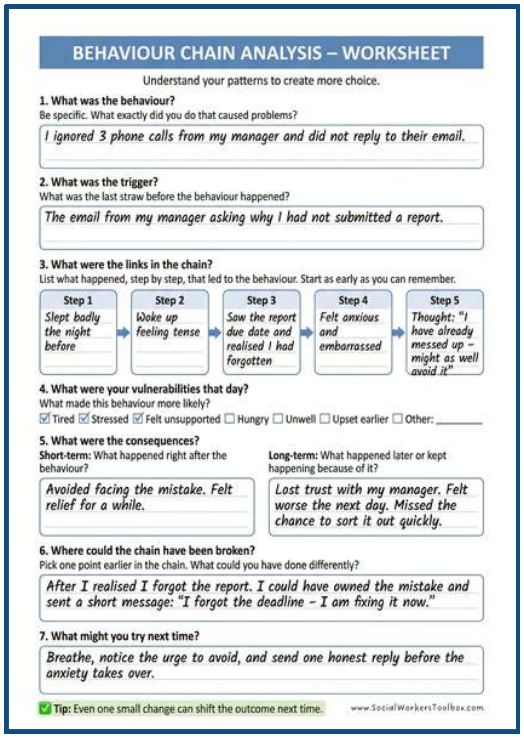
BEHAVIOUR CHAIN ANALYSIS (BCA) Guide &Worksheet

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BEHAVIOUR CHAIN ANALYSIS (BCA)

Sometimes a behaviour causes problems - but it did not come out of nowhere.

Behaviour Chain Analysis is a tool to figure out:
1) What led to the behaviour; 2) What kept it going; 3) Where it could have been stopped.
It helps you understand what happened, without shame or judgement - just the facts.

NAME THE BEHAVIOUR

Be specific.

"I shouted at my colleague."

"I had 3 drinks alone at home."

Not

"I lost it"

Not

"I drank"

WORK BACKWARDS

VULNERABILITIES (What had built up?)

EVENTS (What was going on?)

FEELINGS What did you feel?

THOUGHTS What were you thinking?

TRIGGER (What was the last straw?)

VULNERABILITIES

What made this behaviour more likely that day?

- Not enough sleep
- Stress
- Illness
- Conflict earlier
- Feeling lonely, judged, ignored, or exhausted

Vulnerabilities are not excuses - they are signals.

THE LINKS IN THE CHAIN

List what happened step by step. Each thing led to the next.

Slept badly → Felt tense all day → Got a message from work I did not like → Thought: "They don't respect me" → Felt angry → Snapped at someone

CONSEQUENCES

What happened after the behaviour?

Short-term:

- Relief?
- Release?
- Avoidance?

Long-term:

- Regret?
- Conflict?
- Isolation?
- Stress?

WHERE COULD THE CHAIN BE BROKEN?

Pick one moment earlier in the chain. What else could have happened there?

Thought: 'They don't respect me'

- Taken a break?
- Asked for support?
- Said no?
- Noticed the warning signs?

This is not about blame. It is about having more choice next time.

WHY THIS WORKS

If you can see the chain, you can change it. You cannot control everything - but you can interrupt the pattern. One small shift early on can change the outcome.

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BEHAVIOUR CHAIN ANALYSIS - WORKSHEET

Understand your patterns to create more choice.

1. What was the behaviour?
Be specific. What exactly did you do that caused problems?

2. What was the trigger?
What was the last straw before the behaviour happened?

3. What were the links in the chain?
List what happened, step by step, that led to the behaviour. Start as early as you can remember.

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4	Step 5

4. What were your vulnerabilities that day?
What made this behaviour more likely?

□ Tired □ Stressed □ Felt unsupported □ Hungry □ Unwell □ Upset earlier □ Other:_____

5. What were the consequences?

Short-term: What happened right after the behaviour?

Long-term: What happened later or kept happening because of it?

6. Where could the chain have been broken?
Pick one point earlier in the chain. What could you have done differently?

7. What might you try next time?

✅ **Tip:** Even one small change can shift the outcome next time.

BEHAVIOUR CHAIN ANALYSIS – WORKSHEET

Understand your patterns to create more choice.

1. What was the behaviour?

Be specific. What exactly did you do that caused problems?

I ignored 3 phone calls from my manager and did not reply to their email.

2. What was the trigger?

What was the last straw before the behaviour happened?

The email from my manager asking why I had not submitted a report.

3. What were the links in the chain?

List what happened, step by step, that led to the behaviour. Start as early as you can remember.

Step 1	Step 2	Step 3	Step 4	Step 5
Slept badly the night before	*Woke up feeling tense*	*Saw the report due date and realised I had forgotten*	*Felt anxious and embarrassed*	*Thought: "I have already messed up – might as well avoid it"*

4. What were your vulnerabilities that day?

What made this behaviour more likely?

☑ Tired ☑ Stressed ☑ Felt unsupported ☐ Hungry ☐ Unwell ☐ Upset earlier ☐ Other: _____

5. What were the consequences?

Short-term: What happened right after the behaviour?

Avoided facing the mistake. Felt relief for a while.

Long-term: What happened later or kept happening because of it?

Lost trust with my manager. Felt worse the next day. Missed the chance to sort it out quickly.

6. Where could the chain have been broken?

Pick one point earlier in the chain. What could you have done differently?

After I realised I forgot the report. I could have owned the mistake and sent a short message: "I forgot the deadline – I am fixing it now."

7. What might you try next time?

Breathe, notice the urge to avoid, and send one honest reply before the anxiety takes over.

✅ **Tip:** Even one small change can shift the outcome next time.

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